HOUSE DRAMA



The Uttar Pradesh Vidhan Sabha sessions are known for moments of drama, and this monsoon session didn't disappoint. Samajwadi Party MLA **M. Faheem Irfan** accused the Yogi regime of massive failures in Jal Jeevan Mission work (which provides drinking water to rural areas) to which Jal Shakti minister **Swatantra Dev Singh** shot back: "Swear on your wife that water hasn't reached your village." Irfan quipped that he couldn't risk it since he had to return home to her, but dared the BJP-led government to take up any district and investigate, adding that he'd resign if proved wrong.



PAWAR PUNCHES

The Pawar clan is at it again. At a recent event, NCP (SP) legislator **Rohit Pawar**, in a backhand swipe, said that his uncle and deputy CM **Ajit Pawar**, who heads the rival NCP, was focused on *gavki* (the larger community) and was not paying attention to his *bhavki* (relatives). Never known to be short on retorts, Ajit, who spoke later, shot back saying it was because he took care of his *bhavki* that Rohit had scraped through for a second term from party stronghold Karjat-Jamkhed.

RAID REBOUND



The Enforcement Directorate's raid on Tamil Nadu rural development minister **I. Periyasamy** has left the agency in a spot of bother, with a police case registered against its officials for 'trespassing' on the MLA hostel's premises in Chennai without the Speaker's nod. The complaint, filed by the assembly secretariat, has put the spotlight back on the ED's methods. The ruling DMK alleges the raids are part of the Modi regime's attempts to deflect attention from the "vote chori" allegations.

Kaushik Deka with Avaneesh Mishra, Dhaval S. Kulkarni and Kavitha Muralidharan

TECH WATCH

By **Sonali Acharjee**

HEALTH TRACKER
PUT A RING ON IT

Slipping on a health ring is like wearing a tiny wellness lab on your finger—quietly tracking your body's signals 24/7 without demanding your attention. Unlike watches and bands, rings prioritise recovery and sleep over notifications and workouts: they're lighter, easier to wear to bed, and use data from the highly vascular finger which makes tracking more accurate.



Many health rings are crafted from space-grade titanium or ceramic, making them lightweight, hypoallergenic and durable against scratches or water damage. Some feature infrared sensors for more accurate night-time heart rate tracking, and skin temperature sensors for early illness detection. A few can even double up as your wallet, offering a feature to make contactless payments. Others can predict your menstrual cycle, offer bedtime stories, guided breathing, and even stress alerts—all without a visible screen.

In India, the category is scaling fast. The International Data Corporation (IDC)—a global market intelligence and advisory firm—reports that 323,000 smart rings were shipped in 2024 (up from 113,000 in 2023). IDC counterpart Counterpoint pegged 2024 India sales at $25 million (approx. Rs 217 crore).

Celebrity heat hasn't hurt. The Oura ring has been spotted on Jennifer Aniston, Kim Kardashian and Prince Harry; Indian star Alia Bhatt has also been seen wearing it. Endorsements are also beginning with Ranbir Kapoor fronting a 2025 campaign for Gabit's smart ring. Bottom line: health rings deliver discreet, sleep-first health intelligence, complementing (not replacing) smartwatches. ■